

Who's who: Greater Victoria & Nanaimo

Architects, developers and general contractors who actually build on the Island — who holds the structural seats today, and where KOR has a real door. Prepared for Rory Beirne, Principal, Vancouver Island.

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01 · START HERE

Where we already have a door — and what each is really worth

A first draft of this page claimed four open doors. Verification cut it to one strong one, two conditional, and one that was a different company entirely. The honest version is more useful.

FIRM	KOR HISTORY	VERIFIED POSITION
Townline	36 jobs, last Feb 2026	The one real door. Richmond-based but explicitly building in the Lower Mainland <i>and Vancouver Island</i> . Victoria record: The Hudson / Victoria Public Market heritage conversion, 777 Herald St (26 storeys, 176 homes, Rafii Architects), and Pandora Co-Live (~150 co-live units) just completed. President Rick Ilich.
Westmark Construction	1 job, Dec 2025	Conditional. A Nanaimo GC of 35-plus years with a real multi-family record. But Herold Engineering is their recurring structural partner — named on Songbird Place (structural, civil and envelope), Chelsea at Longwood, Riverstone Place, and a 98-unit Rutherford Road building. This is a displacement conversation.
Omicron	4 jobs, last May 2026	Check before pitching. They built TELUS Living Nanaimo (195 rentals, two six-storey buildings, 400 Fitzwilliam St, completing 2026) — but their own project page credits Omicron with architecture, <i>engineering</i> , construction management and development management in-house. Confirm whether they self-perform structural; the seat may not exist.
Greystar	2 jobs, last Feb 2026	Late, not live. University Heights (597 rental homes, bought from Wesbild in 2022) completes mid-2026 — the structural seat is long gone. Treat as evidence of Greystar's Island appetite for the next one.
de Hoog & Kierulf (dHK)	1 job, Jul 2025	The only architect on this page with a KOR job. Nanaimo office on Dublin Way; Glenn Hill is Principal there.

X REMOVED AFTER VERIFICATION: STARLIGHT

An earlier draft credited our client **Starlight Development** with Harris Green Village. It is a different company. Ours (starlightdevelopment.com) is a private fund doing environment-first luxury retreats across North America and the Caribbean. Harris Green Village belongs to **Starlight Investments** (starlightinvest.com), the Toronto REIT. Same first word, unrelated firms.

02 • THE THREAD

The Island's institutional pipeline is mass timber

This is the single most actionable pattern in the market, and it maps directly onto KOR's CLT and hybrid-timber capability.

- ♦ **VIU Nanaimo student housing** — a 10-storey **hybrid cross-laminated-timber** building, 266 beds, BC Energy Step Code 4, on VIU's district geo-exchange. Opens summer 2027.
- ♦ **Camosun Lansdowne student housing** — six storeys, 423 beds, **mass timber targeting LEED Platinum**. \$154.7M total (\$151.7M province, \$3M college). Ready **early 2029**.

Both flagship post-secondary projects on the Island are timber. Anyone pitching structural here without a timber story is pitching the wrong thing.

03 • COMPETITIVE

Who holds the structural seats

COMPETITOR	WHERE THEY ARE DUG IN
Fast + Epp	Structural on VIU's 266-bed hybrid CLT student housing (architect hcma). The flagship Island mass-timber institutional job — and a competitor has it.
Herold Engineering	Nanaimo civil and structural firm; the recurring structural partner on Westmark projects. Also works with Raymond de Beeld Architect on that team.
RJC Engineers	Maintains a Nanaimo office — a local presence, not a Vancouver firm flying in.

04 • DISCIPLINE

Architects

Island-native practices with a named decision-maker where we have one. None has a KOR job except dHK.

✓ = **name and title verified against the firm's own website, 3 September 2026**. Unmarked names are from Apollo, current as at September 2026 but not individually confirmed — check before a first approach.

- ♦ ✓ **Low Hammond Rowe** — Victoria, 300-1590 Cedar Hill Cross Rd. Partners **Jackson Low, Paul Hammond and Christopher Rowe, all Architects AIBC**. A Victoria partnership since 1985 (renamed in March 2014 when founder Sid Chow retired and Rowe joined). Urban design and large site planning, university buildings, libraries, market and non-market multi-family, seniors housing and care, recreation and community facilities. *The closest fit on this page to KOR's strengths.*

- ♦ **✓ Checkwitch Poiron (CPA)** — Nanaimo + Vancouver. Partners **Ben Checkwitch** and **David Poiron**, who work jointly on every project. Portfolio spans airport and cruise-ship terminals, schools, a hospice, laboratories, warehouses and mixed-use. The principal Nanaimo-headquartered architect.
- ♦ **✓ dHKarchitects (de Hoog & Kierulf)** — **dual office: Victoria (977 Fort St) and Nanaimo (102-5190 Dublin Way).** **Glenn Hill, Partner & Principal Architect AIBC, leads the Nanaimo studio;** Charles Kierulf and Rob Whetter are the other partners. *The one architect here with KOR history — 1 job, July 2025.*
- ♦ **✓ Continuum Architecture** — Victoria. Partners **Lance Steele** (M.Arch, Architect AIBC RAIC AIA — the only registered architect of the three), **Jeremy Beintema** and **Wil Wiens** (both Architectural Technologists AIBC). Victoria's oldest practice, founded 1910, rebranded from KPL James in 2020. Health care (Island Health), UVic, municipal, multi-unit residential. *Note: Brian Kapuscinski and John Pettigrew have both left and are no longer on the firm's roster.*
- ♦ **Cascadia Architects** — Victoria. Principals **Gregory Damant** and **Peter Johannknecht**.
- ♦ **D'Ambrosio architecture + urbanism** — Victoria. Architecture, planning and urban design since 1991. In Deltek, no job yet.
- ♦ **Christine Lintott Architects** — Victoria. **Christine Lintott**, Founding Principal. Founded 2009; regenerative and sustainable community work.
- ♦ **Waymark Architecture** — Victoria. **Will King**, Principal; **Sarah King**, Managing Director.
- ♦ **Raymond de Beeld Architect** — Nanaimo. **A long-time Westmark project partner** — a second route into Westmark-delivered work.
- ♦ **AR Architecture** — Nanaimo. **Ataur Rahman**, Owner/Principal.
- ♦ **Smaller Victoria practices:** Studio 531 · Boldwing Continuum (in Deltek, no job) · Coast + Beam (Pamela Ubeda) · Fold Architects (Sonnen Sloan) · Union Architecture (James Saunders) · Jesse Garlick Architecture · Carolyn Wilson Architect · Colin Harper Architect · BCA Birliga + Crespo (Xavier Cilio).

Developers

- ♦ **Petroglyph Development Group** — Nanaimo. **The best cold target on this page.** Economic arm of Snuneymuxw First Nation, leading **te'tuxwtun**: 102.7 acres of mixed-use land directly south of VIU, land-use plan approved by members 9 May 2026. Early enough that no consultant team is locked, and Indigenous participation is a card KOR already holds through Islander/Gwaii.
- ♦ **Aryze Developments** — Victoria. **Ryan Goodman**, Principal/GM. Among Victoria's most active urban infill developers — Summerhouse, Pearl Block, Seven, and the 12-storey, 91-unit Estoya completing 2027.
- ♦ **Abstract Developments** — Victoria. Premier mid-rise developer: Oak & Stone (87 units), Brooke, Central Block.
- ♦ **Chard Development** — Victoria. Douglas & Caledonia: three towers at 16, 21 and 22 storeys, just over 500 homes including 133 affordable in a BC Housing-backed tower, 2029.
- ♦ **M'akola Development Services** — Island-wide. **Mackenzie Godfrey**, Senior Development Manager. Indigenous-led affordable housing; with BC Housing on Nanaimo 564 Fifth Street.
- ♦ **Jawl Properties** — Victoria. Largest privately held owner and manager of premium office space in Victoria; the family behind Atrium and Gateway Green.
- ♦ **Seacliff Properties · Seba Construction · Viking Properties** — Victoria and West Shore. Origin at the Beachlands and Trailside; Nook & Node and Twelve Cedars; Pavilion in Langford.
- ♦ **Greater Victoria Housing Society · Capital Region Housing Corporation** — non-profit and public affordable-housing developers with live pipelines, on the same funding stream as the BC Housing work.
- ♦ **Invision Developments · Ardent Properties** — active in the Nanaimo market.

- ♦ **Worth a scan, not yet qualified:** Devon Properties · Formwell Homes · Banyan Group · Fort Properties · Pacific Edge Properties · Clover Residential · Urban Thrive · Focus Equities · Merchant House Capital.

06 · DISCIPLINE

General contractors

- ♦ **Knappett Projects** — Victoria, 555 Pembroke St. Pre-construction, construction management, general contracting and design-build, self-performing excavation, concrete formwork, framing and envelope. LEED, BC Step Code and Passivhaus. **Their project managers are all engineers or engineers-in-training** — an engineer-led GC, which should shape how a structural pitch sounds.
- ♦ **Knappett Industries** — Nanaimo, founded 1988. Full-service, Island-wide and across BC. **Related name, separate company** from Knappett Projects — do not merge the two.
- ♦ **Westmark Construction** — Nanaimo. A KOR client (1 job, Dec 2025), but Herold Engineering is the structural incumbent — see section 01.
- ♦ **Farmer Construction** — Victoria. Among the city's largest and most established GCs; commercial and institutional.
- ♦ **Durwest Construction Management** — Victoria. Construction management rather than stipulated-sum general contracting.
- ♦ **Ralmax Group of Companies** — Victoria. Diversified construction group with significant local presence.
- ♦ **The rest of the established regional field:** Kinetic Construction · Campbell Construction · Windley Contracting · Hazelwood Group · Verity Construction · Brenric Construction · CMF Construction · Tectonica Management · Island Heights Construction.

07 · WHERE THE MONEY IS

The institutional pipeline

1

Nanaimo Regional General Hospital

Concept planning underway for a **new patient tower** plus cardiac and acute expansion, and a new Nanaimo Cancer Centre. Concept plan due **summer 2027** — consultant selection is ahead of us, not behind.

2

Victoria General Hospital energy centre

\$75.6M (Province via Island Health \$52.9M, Capital Regional Hospital District \$22.7M), building summer 2026 to 2029. Island Health's own release frames it as resilience against **power outages, earthquakes and flooding** — a seismic brief in all but name.

3

Camosun Lansdowne

423 beds, six storeys, **mass timber, LEED Platinum**. \$154.7M. Ready early 2029.

4

VIU Nanaimo

266 beds, 10 storeys, **hybrid CLT**, opens summer 2027. hcma architect, **Fast + Epp structural**.

5

te'tuxwtun, Nanaimo

102.7 acres, Snuneymuxw-led via Petroglyph, approved 9 May 2026. The largest single land play in the Nanaimo market.

6

BC Housing, Nanaimo

564 Fifth Street with M'akola (34 replacement homes plus ~165 new, construction 2028) and 250 Terminal Avenue.

Market backdrop: Q1 2026 housing starts — Saanich 195, Langford 171, Colwood 143, City of Victoria 117. March starts fell 64% year over year, while missing-middle activity doubled on the back of provincial Bill 44. Roughly 118 active pre-construction developments across Greater Victoria.

08 · METHOD

Honest labels

- ♦ **KOR history is ours** — job counts, last-job dates and Deltek client links from our own records. Reliable.
- ♦ **Market facts are public sources verified 3 September 2026** — Island Health, BC Government, VIU, Camosun, BC Housing, firm websites and regional press. Where two sources disagreed, the claim was dropped rather than guessed: Knappett's founding year (sources said both 27 and 40 years) and a reported "\$103M RCMP detachment" (single weak source, and the figure collided with VIU's provincial funding) are both out.
- ♦ **⚠ Contact names are Apollo-sourced and not individually verified.** Titles were current in Apollo as at September 2026. Confirm before a first approach — our own contact data separately carries known duplicate-affiliation and stale-role problems.
- ♦ **⚠ An external tool told us this market was "completely greenfield — zero worked-with".** That is wrong. It reflects that Apollo's CRM is not populated by KOR, not our actual history. Our records show Townline at 36 jobs, Omicron 4, Greystar 2, Westmark 1, dHK 1. Where a tool and our own ledger disagree, the ledger wins.
- ♦ **⚠ This is NOT built on our project inventory.** BC Stats discontinued the Major Projects Inventory — last issue Q3 2025, page removed 30 June 2026 — so our BC pipeline data stops there and cannot be refreshed from that source.
- ♦ **Firm lists are the significant players, not a census.** Absence means "not surfaced as significant in this pass", not "does not matter".

KOR Structural — Confidential / Internal · Prepared for Rory Beirne, Principal Vancouver Island · v2, verified 3 September 2026

Firms, competitive positions and market facts from this research are decomposed into the BD platform as typed org facts, so the next pass starts here rather than from scratch.